

Srajit M Kumar

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Education

Institut Südasiens, Universität Heidelberg

PhD South Asian History

2024- Ongoing.

Dissertation Title (Working): Time, Work, and Politics: The Kanpur Working Classes, 1880s - 1950s

University of Delhi, New Delhi.

MA History

2020-2022. Specialisation: Modern Indian History.

Relevant Coursework: Labour History, History of Gender, History of Revolutionary Thought, History of Economic Thought, History of Education.

Jamia Millia Islamia, New Delhi.

BA (Hons) History

2017-2020

Relevant Coursework: Ancient Indian Politics and Society, Medieval Indian Economy, Politics and Society, Modern History, History of the World, History of Gender in India, History of Imperialism and Anti-Imperialist Movements in Asia and Africa, Women's Writing in India, International Finance.

Honours and Awards

Research Bursary

Society for the Study of Labour History (SSLH), Great Britain

Awarded a research bursary to do archival research at the British Library, London, and the Centre for South Asian Studies (CSAS), University of Cambridge in August and September, 2025.

Link to Report:

<https://sslh.org.uk/2026/01/21/srajit-m-kumar-heidelberg-on-time-and-the-working-class-movement-in-20th-century-north-india/>

PhD Research Grant

Research Grants - Doctoral Programmes in Germany, 2024/25

Deutscher Akademischer Austauschdienst (DAAD), Bonn, Germany.

Awarded the prestigious DAAD scholarship to pursue a PhD at the South Asia Institute, University of Heidelberg, from 2024 onwards.

PhD Research Grant

Landesgraduiertenförderung (LGF), Graduiertenakademie der Universität Heidelberg, 2024

Declined due to the award of the DAAD fellowship

Assistant Professor (History)
National Eligibility Test
University Grants Commission, Government of India.
December 2022 Cycle.

Experience

Disha India Community School
Consultant, Oral History Project (Freelance)

Village Padha, Karnal, Haryana.
Nov 2023 — July 2024.

Overseeing the writing of a history of the village by the students of Grade 7, Disha India Community School.
This involves:

- Taking workshops at the school on how to conduct and write oral histories.
- Creating questionnaires that the students can use as reference while interviewing.
- Editing the written material.

Disha India Education Trust
Designer and Facilitator (Freelance)

New Delhi, India.
July 2022 — February 2024.

Designing the syllabus for historical expeditions undertaken under the Experiential Learning method for Grade 6 and 8 students of Heritage Xperiential Learning School, Gurgaon. This revolves around How A Historian Works and the Revolt of 1857. This includes:

- Scouting out places where the expeditions can take place in terms of historical relevance and crowd control.
- Since October 2023, I have also been involved in training other facilitators in the experiential method of education.
- Designing interactive activities that ease the process of learning and make sure different styles of learning are incorporated.
- Preparing workbooks that would help the students keep a log of what they did throughout the day.
- Collecting resources like maps, photographs, and preparing them so that the students could get a better picture of what they are doing.
- Handling groups of 15 students. This involves making them comfortable around you, figuring out their individual learning styles, and incorporating them into the plan.
- Making sure that other people also finish the day on time, while co-ordinating with the school and the parents.

Centre for the Study of Developing Societies (CSDS)
Research Assistant

New Delhi, India.
Dec 2023 - Jan 2024.

I was employed as a research assistant at the Parekh Institute of Indian Thought under Prof. Rajeev Bhargava.

- Assisting the members of the institute with reading the works of Tulsidas in the Awadhi language.
- Preparing a detailed bibliography of the social and intellectual history of 16th century India.
- Arranging and attending lectures of scholars who have been working on the same areas.

Oil and Natural Gas Corporation of India (ONGC) Foundation
PS to the CEO
Intern

New Delhi, India.
Jun 2023 — Aug 2023.
Mar 2023 — Jun 2023

- Assisting the CEO of ONGC Foundation with day-to-day activities.
- Managing a team of 4 interns and supervising their work.
- Drafting documents related to both administration and policy, including official correspondence with various government departments.
- Co-ordinating between the offices of ONGC Foundation, Laxmi Nagar, and ONGC CSR, Vasant Kunj.
- Scrutinising CSR proposals received by ONGC and recommending them to the CEO of ONGC Foundation.
- Drafting documents both internal and external — Reports, Proposals, Minutes of Meetings, Board Agendas, etc.
- Working on the SAP database management system and turning them into legible documents through Excel.
- Editing PowerPoint presentations regarding ONGC CSR.

Naqshabaddh (MapBound)
Convenor and Walk Leader

New Delhi, India.
Jul 2022 — March 2023.

I established my own heritage portal.

- Right now, we have had two heritage walks: The Cinemas of Old Delhi, or How Old Cities interact with Modernity, and Delhi 1739.
- A social media account. (<https://www.instagram.com/naqshabaddh/>)

The Partition Museum
Oral History and Research Intern

Delhi, India.
Feb 2022 — Apr 2022.

Worked for the Hope Gallery of the Partition Museum, Kashmere Gate, Delhi. This gallery displays stories of moments of hope felt by the survivors of the 1947 partition during or after their migration to India. This involved:

- Getting in touch with partition survivors and their representative organisations in Delhi.
- Conducting long-form video interviews of Partition survivors and recording them.
- Going through the footage and finding material for the gallery.
- Subtitling the relevant parts.
- Translating these subtitles into Hindi (if they were in English) and vice versa.
- Going through work that had been done prior to my joining and proofreading and translating subtitles.
- Helping catalogue donations that the survivors had for the museum.

Dastaan: Stories to Tell
Walk Leader

New Delhi, India.
Nov 2021 - Dec 2021.

Redid a few old heritage walks in Delhi after tourism started again after the easing of COVID restrictions in 2021. Relevant Walks included:

- The Social History of 1940s and 50s Delhi through Khan Market.

- The Architectural Language of 1950s India through Mandi House
- How Old Cities interact with modernity: The Cinemas of Old Delhi.

The Random Delhi
Walk Leader

New Delhi, India.
Jun 2019 — Feb 2020.

Relevant walks included:

- The story of Post-partition Delhi at Khan Market.
- The cultural history of New Delhi at Mandi House.

The execution of these walks usually includes:

- Scouting out routes, which would cover places of interest and fit into the narrative while ensuring the walk remains physically inclusive for different age groups and the differently abled.
- Researching micro-histories of localities using both oral and written sources.
- Connecting micro-histories to larger histories of the city.
- Making sure that all this research is presented in an engaging and accessible manner.
- Crowd control.

Sahapedia
Walk Leader

New Delhi, India.
Apr 2019 - Feb 2020.

I started doing heritage walks for Sahapedia in 2019, until the Indian Heritage Walk Festival of 2019.

Relevant walks included:

- The Cinemas of Old Delhi
- The history of Mandi house
- The trees of New Delhi, or horticultural imperialism.

Publications

A Tale of Two Broken Promises, and the Rise of Muslim Ghettos in India

Frontline Magazine (Online)

10 March, 2024.

<https://frontline.thehindu.com/the-nation/a-tale-of-two-broken-promises-how-partition-betrayed-muslims-who-stayed-in-india/article67932108.ece>

Why Opposing NCERT Textbook Revisions Isn't Enough

NewsClick (Online)

28 April, 2023.

<https://www.newsclick.in/why-opposing-ncert-textbook-revisions-isnt-enough/>

Remembering To Forget

Frontline Magazine (Print and Online)

1 December, 2022.

<https://frontline.thehindu.com/social-issues/social-justice/essay-remembering-the-dalit-experience-of-partition-on-ambekar-death-anniversary/article66168417.ece>

Forgotten Refugees of Partition
Outlook Magazine (Online)

7 July, 2022.

<https://www.outlookindia.com/national/the-forgotten-refugees-of-partition-news-207061>

Draft EIA Notification 2020: An Assessment
The Jamia Review (Online)

1 Oct, 2020

<https://www.thejamiareview.com/draft-eia-notification-2020-an-assessment/>

Shiv Nath Prasad and Delhi's Brutalist Architecture
The Random Delhi (Online)

11 May, 2020

<https://therandomdelhi.wordpress.com/2020/05/11/shiv-nath-prasad-and-delhis-brutalist-architecture/>

Conference Presentations

Summer Semester Colloquium, South Asia Institute, University of Heidelberg
Summer Semester, 2026-27 (forthcoming)
Paper Title: TBA

Labour Network, The Oxford Centre for Research in the Humanities, Humanities Division, University of Oxford
June 2026 (forthcoming)
Paper Title: The Strike as a Waiting Game: Temporality and Working-Class Politics in Kanpur, 1924-38

European Council for South Asian Studies (ECSAS) Bi-Annual Conference, held in Heidelberg, Germany.
October 2025
Paper Title: *Tamasha* at the Parade Ground: Sonic Dissent and the Creation of a Crisis in 20th Century Kanpur.

International Conference on Nights and Nocturnalities in South Asia, Leibniz Zentrum Moderner-Orient (ZMO), Berlin.
November 2024.
Paper Title: Time, (Non) Work and Labour: Kanpur, 1880s-1950s.

Winter Semester Colloquium, South Asia Institute, University of Heidelberg
Winter Semester, 2024-25.
Paper Title: Time is Money and Work is Worship: the Case of Kanpur in the 20th Century.

Cambridge Gender and Sexuality History Workshop
Michaelmas Term, 2021 (Online).
Paper Title: Looking At Gandhi Through Koselleck's Lens: Towards A Conceptual History Of Gandhi's Brahmacharya

National Seminar On Indian History Writing Traditions, India International Centre, New Delhi
India International Centre, 2020.
Paper Title: Who Owns The Forest?: A Debate in 1880s India.

Languages

Mother Tongue: Hindi

English: IELTS Overall Band: 8.5. Listening: 9.0, Reading: 8.5, Writing: 7.0, Speaking: 8.5. CEFR Level: C2.

Urdu: Reading, Writing, Understanding, and Speaking.

Gujarati: Reading, Writing, and Understanding.